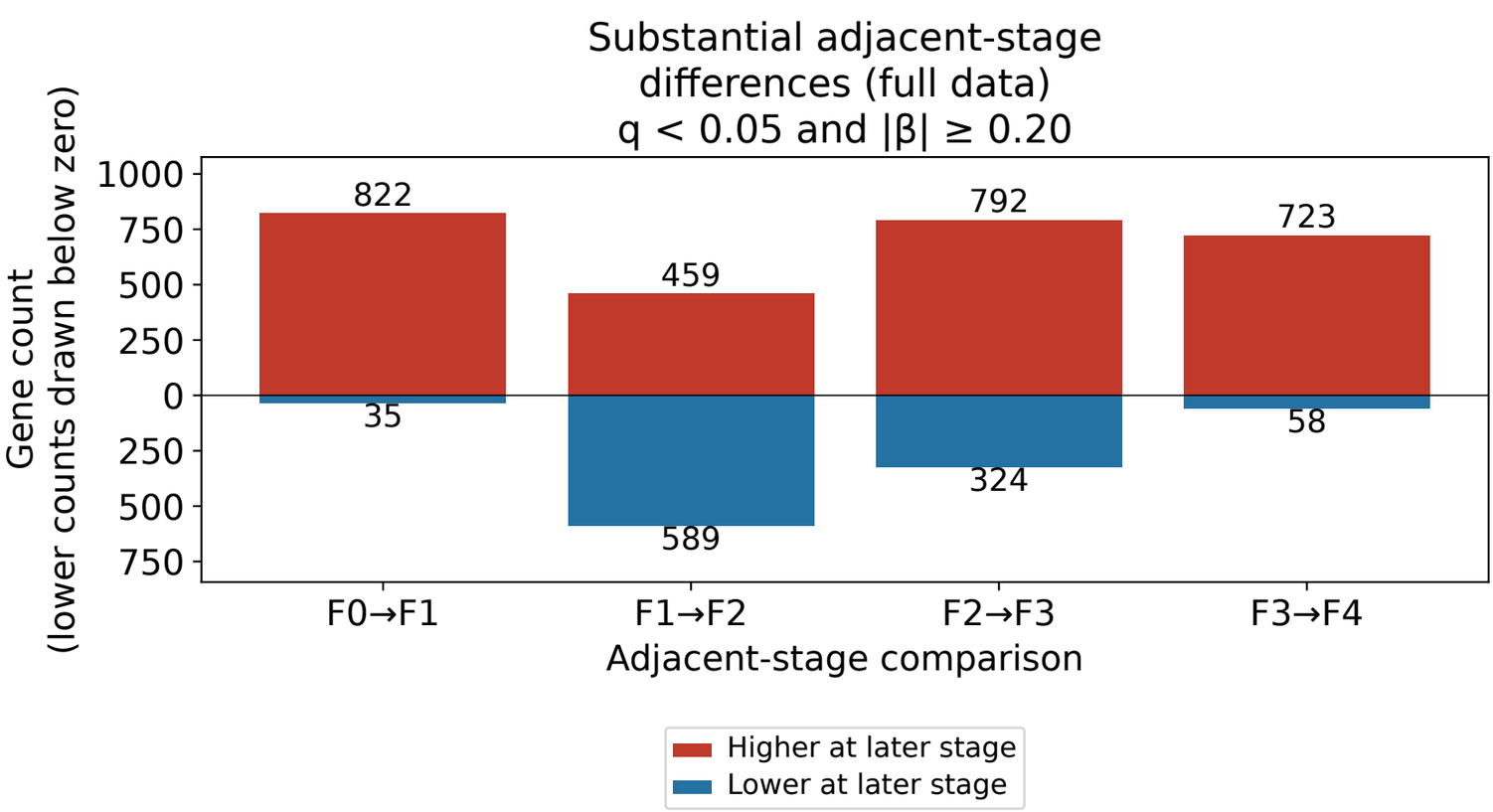
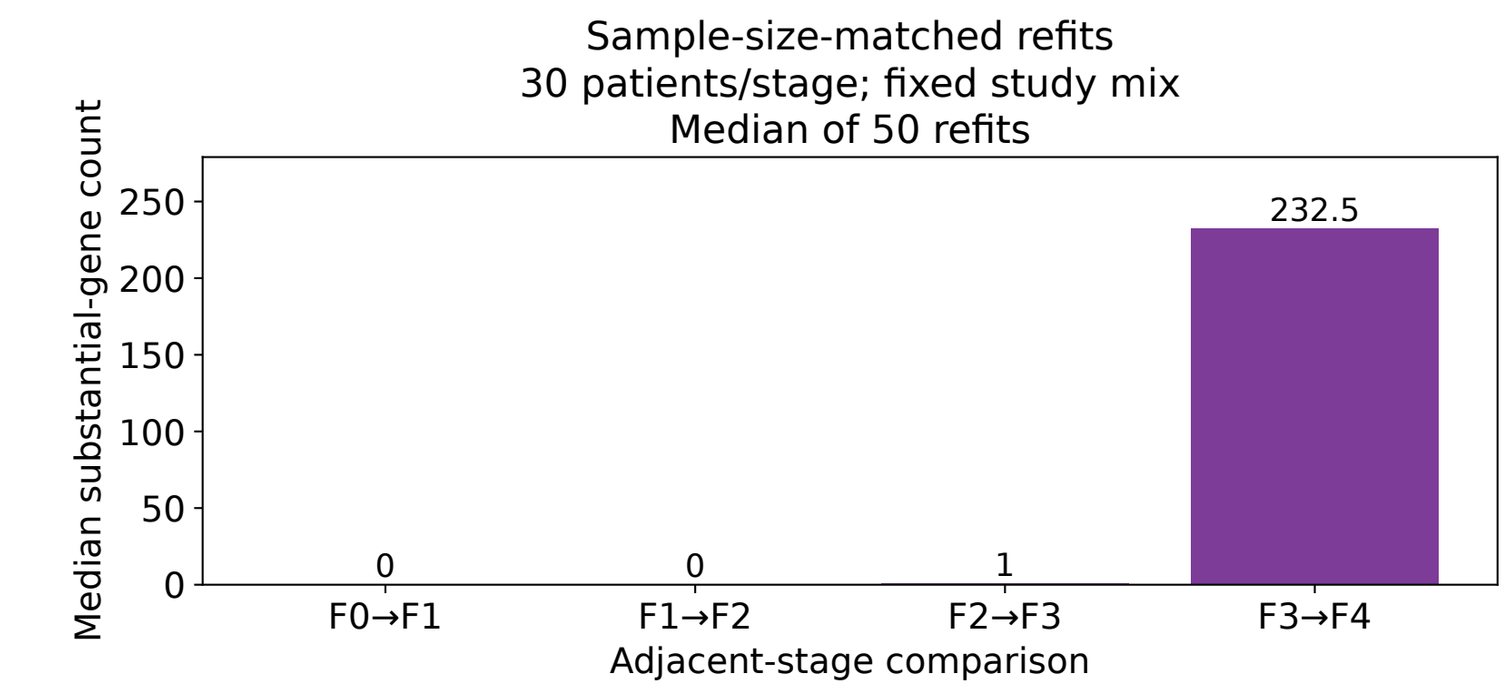
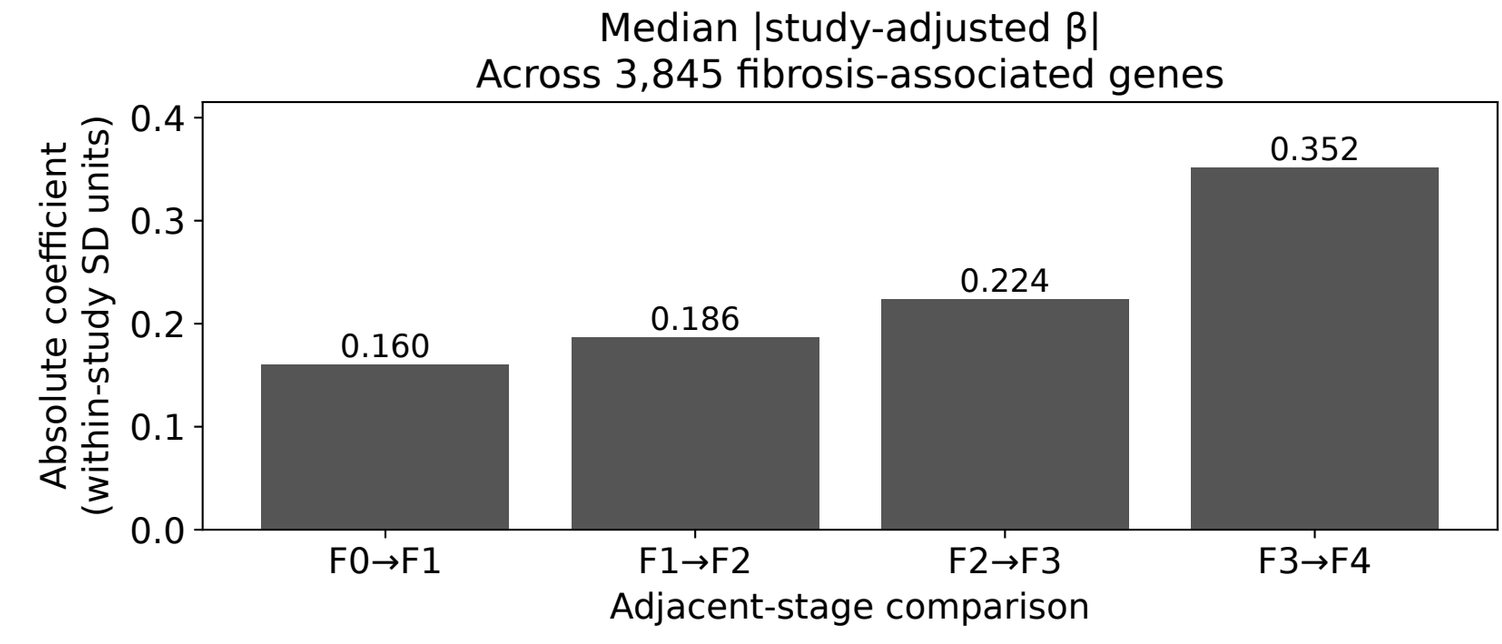

Substantial adjacent-stage differences (full data)
q < 0.05 and |β| ≥ 0.20
Gene count (lower counts drawn below zero)
1000
750
500
250
0
250
500
750
822
459
792
723
35
589
324
58
F0→F1
F1→F2
F2→F3
F3→F4
Adjacent-stage comparison
Higher at later stage
Lower at later stage


Sample-size-matched refits
30 patients/stage; fixed study mix
Median of 50 refits
Median substantial-gene count
250
200
150
100
50
0
0
0
1
232.5
F0→F1
F1→F2
F2→F3
F3→F4
Adjacent-stage comparison


Median |study-adjusted β|
Across 3,845 fibrosis-associated genes
Absolute coefficient (within-study SD units)
0.4
0.3
0.2
0.1
0.0
0.160
0.186
0.224
0.352
F0→F1
F1→F2
F2→F3
F3→F4
Adjacent-stage comparison